



SLEEP, BABY. PLEASE.

The Perfect Sleep Environment

CHECKLIST PLANNER

"Get the room right once. Then it works every night."

Room-by-room setup tracker · Item-by-item safe sleep checklist
Environment optimisation from Chapter 5 and the Safe Sleep Bonus
Nightly condition log · Temperature & light level tracker

Print and post in the nursery.

Safe Sleep

Chapter 5

Nightly Log

Temp & Light

TOG Guide

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Setup Checklist

Nightly Log

Six & Thriving

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How to Use This Planner

Three parts. Complete them in order. Post the nightly check on the nursery door.

Part 1 · One-Time Setup Checklist

Work through each category room by room. Tick every item when it is installed and confirmed. This is your setup audit — do it before sleep training begins.

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Part 2 · Nightly Condition Check

A quick 10-point pre-sleep check to run every night at bedtime. Post page 7 on the nursery door or fridge.

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Part 3 · Temperature & Light Log

Log room temperature, white noise dB, and blackout status for 14 nights. Patterns in these numbers explain patterns in sleep.

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Reference pages included:

- TOG Guide — sleep sack weight by room temperature
- Quick-Reference Standards — darkness / white noise / temperature benchmarks
- Safe Sleep 10 — the non-negotiable rules from the Bonus Section

"Get the room right once. Then it works every night."

Six & Thriving — Sleep, Baby. Please.

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SETUP CHECKLIST

The Sleep Space

One-Time Setup Checklist · Safe Sleep — Bonus Section

■ 6 items to install and confirm

Ref: Safe Sleep — Bonus Section

Critical Firm, flat mattress — no pillow-top, wedge, or incline

Confirmed:

☐

Soft surfaces are the #1 SIDS risk. Non-negotiable.

Critical Crib / bassinet / play yard — not swing or car seat

Confirmed:

☐

Sleep-specific surfaces only. Inclined surfaces are not safe for unattended sleep.

Critical Fitted sheet ONLY — no blankets, bumpers, pillows, or positioners

Confirmed:

☐

One fitted sheet. Nothing else inside the sleep space.

Critical Mattress fits snugly — no gap larger than two fingers at any edge

Confirmed:

☐

Gaps are a head entrapment hazard.

Setup Sleep sack selected and correctly sized for current weight

Confirmed:

☐

Replace loose blankets with a wearable blanket / sleep sack.

Setup Monitor positioned outside the crib — not inside, not attached to rails

Confirmed:

☐

Baby should not be able to reach cables or device.

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SETUP CHECKLIST

Darkness & Light

One-Time Setup Checklist · Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

■ 6 items to install and confirm

Ref: Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

Critical True blackout curtains or blinds installed

Confirmed:

☐

True blackout = you cannot see your hand in front of your face with the door closed.

Setup All window edges sealed — no light bleed around curtain edges

Confirmed:

☐

Use Velcro or curtain tape to seal gaps. Even a sliver matters.

Setup All device and monitor LEDs covered or disabled

Confirmed:

☐

Cover with electrical tape or use a device with no standby light. Baby melatonin is sensitive.

Setup Baby monitor screen set to off / auto-sleep (audio-only during sleep)

Confirmed:

☐

The monitor display does not need to be on while baby sleeps.

Setup No nightlight, or red-spectrum nightlight only (>600nm wavelength)

Confirmed:

☐

Blue and white light suppresses melatonin. Red spectrum is the safe option.

Setup Hall light / landing light cannot seep under the nursery door

Confirmed:

☐

Use a door draught excluder or seal gap with a rolled towel as a test.

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SETUP CHECKLIST

Sound & White Noise

One-Time Setup Checklist · Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

■ 5 items to install and confirm

Ref: Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

Setup White noise machine selected and positioned

Confirmed:

☐

Place at least 7 feet from the crib, or on the opposite side of the room.

Setup White noise level calibrated to 60–65 dB at baby's head height

Confirmed:

☐

Use a free decibel meter app. The AAP recommends no louder than 65 dB.

Setup White noise is steady / continuous — not music or nature sounds with breaks

Confirmed:

☐

Breaks in sound can trigger micro-arousals. Steady 'shush' or fan noise is ideal.

Setup Household door is solid enough to buffer outside noise

Confirmed:

☐

Add a door sweep or use white noise louder if there is significant outside noise.

Setup Phone notification sounds off or phone removed from nursery

Confirmed:

☐

A sudden ping during a light sleep cycle can cause a full waking.

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SETUP CHECKLIST

Temperature

One-Time Setup Checklist · Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

■ 5 items to install and confirm

Ref: Chapter 5 — Setting the Stage

Setup Room thermometer installed at baby's level (not ceiling)

Confirmed:

☐

Temperature is significantly different at floor level vs ceiling level.

Critical Room temperature between 68–72°F / 20–22°C confirmed at baby's height

Confirmed:

☐

Overheating is a SIDS risk factor. Err cool rather than warm.

Setup Sleep sack TOG rating matches room temperature

Confirmed:

☐

0.5 TOG: 75°F+ / 24°C+ | 1.0 TOG: 69–75°F / 20–24°C | 2.5 TOG: <69°F / 20°C

Setup Heating / cooling vent not blowing directly onto sleep surface

Confirmed:

☐

Direct airflow can cause temperature swings and skin dryness.

Setup Humidity checked — ideal 40–60% relative humidity

Confirmed:

☐

Dry air irritates airways. A cool-mist humidifier can help in dry climates.

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SETUP CHECKLIST

Nursery Layout & Feeding Station

One-Time Setup Checklist · Chapter 4 & 5

■ 5 items to install and confirm

Ref: Chapter 4 & 5

Setup Feeding chair positioned for night-feed access without full lights on Confirmed:

☐ Minimise brightness during night feeds — keep melatonin intact.

Setup Nappy change station stocked and within arm's reach

Confirmed:

☐ Everything accessible in the dark: nappies, wipes, cream, spare PJs.

Setup A small red or amber night-feed light available (not overhead light)

Confirmed:

☐ A red spectrum lamp or head torch for night feeds only.

Setup White noise continues during brief night wakings

Confirmed:

☐ Do not turn off white noise for night feeds — it masks household sounds.

Setup Spare sleep sack accessible without searching

Confirmed:

☐ Keep one pre-sized spare in the drawer for night leaks or overheating.

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NIGHTLY — POST THIS PAGE

Nightly Condition Check

Run this checklist every bedtime. 60 seconds. Post on nursery door.

Complete before placing baby in the sleep space — every sleep, every time.



Room dark?

True blackout confirmed — no light leaks



All LEDs covered?

Monitor, chargers, air purifier displays



White noise on?

Running at correct level before baby enters room



Baby on back?

Start every sleep on their back



Room temp 68–72°F?

Confirmed at crib level, not ceiling thermostat



Feed complete?

Baby not fed to full sleep — drowsy but awake



Sleep sack correct TOG?

Appropriate for tonight's room temperature



White noise steady?

Not on timer — will stay on all night



Fitted sheet only?

No loose items added to crib since last check



Parent calm?

Your energy transfers. Take one slow breath first.



Remember: your nervous system sets the tone.

One slow breath before you enter the room. Calm parent = calm baby.

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NIGHTLY LOG

Temperature & Light Log

14-night environment tracker — patterns in these numbers explain patterns in sleep.

Night	Date	Room Temp (°F/°C)	WN Level (dB)	Blackout?	Baby Temp Feel	TOG Used	Sleep Quality	Notes
1				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
2				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
3				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
4				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
5				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
6				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
7				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
8				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
9				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
10				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
11				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
12				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
13				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	
14				Y ☐ N ☐ C ☐	OK ☐ W ☐		☆☆☆☆☆	

Baby temp feel key:

C = Cool (add layer)

OK = Comfortable

W = Warm (remove layer)

Sleep quality: Circle 1–5 stars (1 = frequent wakings, 5 = slept through)

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REFERENCE

Environment Standards — Quick Reference

Chapter 5 · Tape this page to the nursery wall or inside the wardrobe door.

Standards at a Glance

Category	Standard	Detail	Status
Darkness	Total blackout	Can't see hand in front of face	
	Near blackout	Small gap or light bleed	
	Light present	Any visible ambient light	
White Noise	60–65 dB ideal	Measured at baby's head height	
	< 60 dB	May not mask household sounds	
	> 65 dB	Too loud — reduce immediately	
Temperature	68–72°F / 20–22°C	Ideal sleep temperature	
	72–75°F / 22–24°C	Warm — use lighter TOG	
	> 75°F / > 24°C	Too warm — cooling required	
Humidity	40–60% RH	Optimal for airways	
	< 40% RH	Dry — consider cool-mist humidifier	

TOG Guide — Sleep Sack Weight by Room Temperature

Room Temperature	TOG Rating	Baby Clothing Layer
< 61°F / < 16°C	3.5 TOG	Vest + 3.5 TOG sleep sack
61–68°F / 16–20°C	2.5 TOG	Vest + long sleeves + 2.5 TOG
68–72°F / 20–22°C	1.0 TOG	Vest + 1.0 TOG sleep sack
72–75°F / 22–24°C	0.5 TOG	Short sleeve vest + 0.5 TOG
> 75°F / > 24°C	0.2 TOG or none	Vest only or very light wrap

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SAFE SLEEP

Safe Sleep — The Non-Negotiables

Bonus Section of Sleep, Baby. Please. · Post this in the nursery and share with all caregivers.

These rules apply for every sleep — naps and nights — until your baby's first birthday.

- 1 ☐ Firm, flat surface — no incline, no pillow-top Date confirmed:
- 2 ☐ Baby on their BACK — every sleep, every time Date confirmed:
- 3 ☐ Fitted sheet only in the sleep space Date confirmed:
- 4 ☐ Sleep sack, not a loose blanket Date confirmed:
- 5 ☐ Room 68–72°F / 20–22°C Date confirmed:
- 6 ☐ True blackout — hand invisible in front of face Date confirmed:
- 7 ☐ White noise at 60–65 dB — not inside the crib Date confirmed:
- 8 ☐ All LEDs covered or disabled Date confirmed:
- 9 ☐ No nightlight, or red-spectrum only Date confirmed:
- 10 ☐ Sleep space dedicated — not swing or car seat Date confirmed:

Caregiver Sign-Off — Everyone who cares for this baby has read and agrees to these rules.

Primary caregiver

Signature / date

Partner / co-parent

Signature / date

Grandparent / nanny

Signature / date

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